

The Nine Days and Tisha b'Av 5782

Tzemach Tzedek Community Centre

*Special features of the lead-up to Tisha b'Av for 5782,
shown here for future historical purposes only,
since we are confidently awaiting the coming of Mashiach.*

1. All the restrictions and limitations of the "Nine Days" commence on Rosh Chodesh (this year on Thurs evening 28 July) and continue until after the end of the actual fast. This year, with the date of 9 (Tisha) b'Av being on a Shabbos, the fast is postponed to 10 Av.
2. When Av enters, we reduce our joy and minimise any business involvement that leads to joy.
3. We do not purchase new clothes or shoes, nor do we commission someone to make them. We do not do laundry (except for the clothes of young children). These rules apply even if the clothes or shoes will not be worn until after the end of the fast. One may, however, give one's Shabbos clothes to a non-Jewish launderer.
4. We do not wear clothes for the first time after they were laundered, even if they were laundered before the start of Av, except in honour of Shabbos. However, if there is a bris, then the father, the mohel and the sandek may wear laundered clothes and their Shabbos garments.
5. We do not eat meat or drink wine, except on Shabbos or at a seudas mitzvah.
6. We do not wash our entire body for pleasure, even in cold water. However, for health purposes and purposes associated with a mitzvah, it is permitted.
7. A person who washes with hot water and/or toivels himself in the mikveh every Friday may wash with hot water without soap (others do permit soap) and toivel himself on this Friday (Rosh Chodesh Av) and also next Friday, Erev Shabbos Devarim/ Chazon.
8. On Shabbos, the Alter Rebbe would wear all his customary Shabbos clothing, without any deviation from his usual pattern, even on Shabbos Chazon.
9. On motzaei Shabbos 2 Av (this year 30 July) we make Havdalah on wine, but we give the wine to a child who is mature enough to appreciate the importance of making a brocha before drinking, but is not mature enough to appreciate the obligation to mourn over Yerushalayim. If there is no such child available, the person making Havdalah should drink the wine.
10. **Shabbos Devarim, Chazon:** this year it is on 9 Av: All the restrictions that apply to Torah study on a regular erev Tisha b'Av apply on this Shabbos as well, from chatzot hayom (this year at 12:01pm) onwards. We may study only the books of Eichah and Iyov, the unfavourable prophecies in the book of Yirmeyahu, Midrash Eichah and the description of the churban as recorded in the Talmud Maseches Gittin 55b. The activities prohibited on Tisha b'Av that are private in nature are prohibited on this Shabbos as well.
11. We may eat meat and drink wine at the meal on Shabbos afternoon before the Fast. However, one should not feast with company.
12. All eating and drinking must be finished by shkia (sunset), this year at 5:19pm. Benching may be after shkia.
13. At motzaei Shabbos 9 Av (5:58pm), say "*Baruch hamavdil bein kodesh l'chol*". Then put on non-leather shoes.
14. In the synagogue or at home for Maariv, we sit on low chairs/stools or cushions. The shule furniture is not suitable and it will not be available, so bring your own.
15. After Maariv, we say the beracha "*...Borei me'orei ha'esh*" over a flame. However, Havdalah is not said.
16. We continue to sit on low chairs or cushions and read Megillas Eichah and selected Kinos, then say "*Ve'Atah Kadosh...*", a full kaddish, Aleinu and kiddush yatom.
17. A person who is sitting shiva (chas v'shalom) may be in shul in the evening and morning until the Kinos are finished, because we are all in mourning on this day.
18. In the morning of the Fast day (this year on 10 Av / Sun 7 Aug), upon rising from sleep, a person should wash only his fingers, and not the entire hand. If he has sleep around his eyes, and he would normally wash it off, he may do so on this occasion as well. We do not say the beracha "*...she'asah li kal tzarki*" until the next morning.
19. We do not greet one another on the Fast day.
20. **Shacharis:** no tallis or tefillin, and we do not kiss the tzizis of the tallis katan. We say Kinos after the Haftorah. It is customary for each person to say Megillas Eichah individually after the Kinos. We do not say the Tehillim of the day or "*Ein Kelokenu...*" until the afternoon.

21. Until chatzot hayom (this year at 12:01pm) we don't do any work that involves some time or concentration. Similarly, we do not sit on regular chairs or prepare food for the evening meal until after chatzot hayom.
22. **Before Mincha:** from chatzot hayom (this year at 12:01pm) and onwards we may put on tallis and tefillin saying the appropriate berachos. Then we say the Shema, shir haYom, Ein k'elokeinu, the portion of Tehillim for the day and any shiurim which normally follow Shacharis. That concludes the omissions made in Shacharis. From Mincha Gedolah (this year 12:29pm) we may start saying the korbonos for Mincha, then continue with Krias haTorah and Haftarah, followed by Shmonei Esrei etc.
23. **After Mincha:** we put on Rabbeinu Tam tefillin and say the usual passages.
24. **Ending the Fast:** at 5:46pm. We daven Maariv, wash negel vasser (no beracha), wash our faces and rinse our mouths. We can wear leather shoes again. We make Havdalah over wine: we say "...*Borei pri hagafen*" and the Havdalah beracha, then drink the wine. We don't use a candle or spices.
25. Make Kiddush Levanah.
26. We do not eat meat or drink wine until the morning of 11 Av (Mon 8 Aug). However, the other restrictions of the Nine Days are now removed.

*Any person who mourns for Yerushalayim will merit to see the celebrations when she is rebuilt.
May we merit to greet Mashiach and join with other Yidden at the third Beis haMikdash.*

(The above notes include material adapted from the Luach Kollel Chabad.)